How organizations are rewiring to capture value

Organizations are beginning to create the structures and processes that lead to meaningful value from gen AI. While still in early days, companies are redesigning workflows, elevating governance, and mitigating more risks.

78%

of organizations use AI in at least one business function

vs. 72% in early 2024

71%

of respondents report using gen AI in at least one business function.

21%

of gen-AI adopters have redesigned workflows, but it's the #1 driver of EBIT gains.

17%

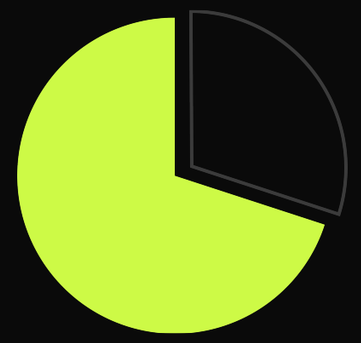
of organizations attribute ≥5% of EBIT to gen AI in the past 12 months.

Survey & Methodology

This survey, conducted in **July 2024**, captures insights from 1,491 respondents across 101 countries, weighted by GDP
for balanced representation.
Participants span a diverse range of company sizes, industries,
and functional roles, providing a comprehensive view of how organizations worldwide are adopting and managing AI.

Trends in AI

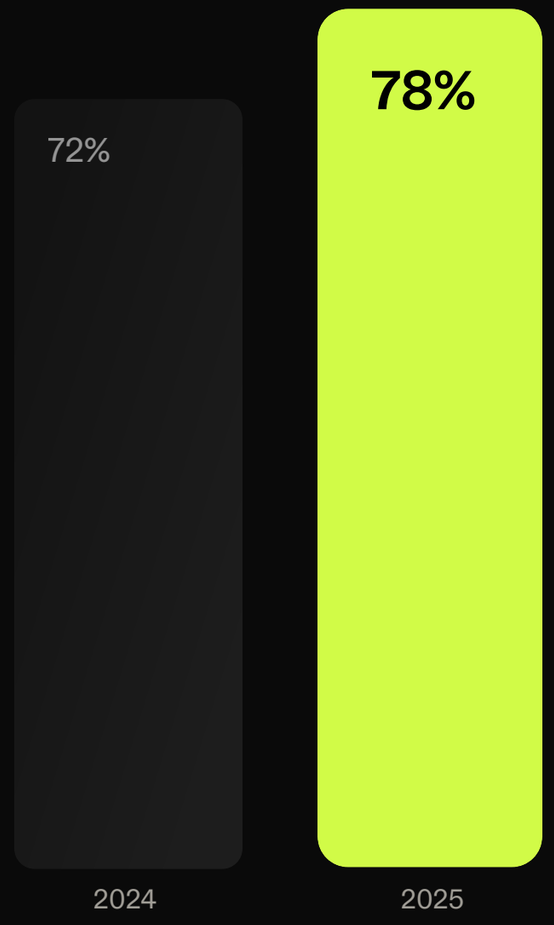
AI has moved from experimentation to mainstream business use, with generative AI adoption accelerating across multiple functions. Organizations are no longer limiting AI to pilots; they are expanding its role in core areas such as marketing, operations, product development, and IT. This shift marks a transition from isolated use cases to broader, enterprise-level integration.



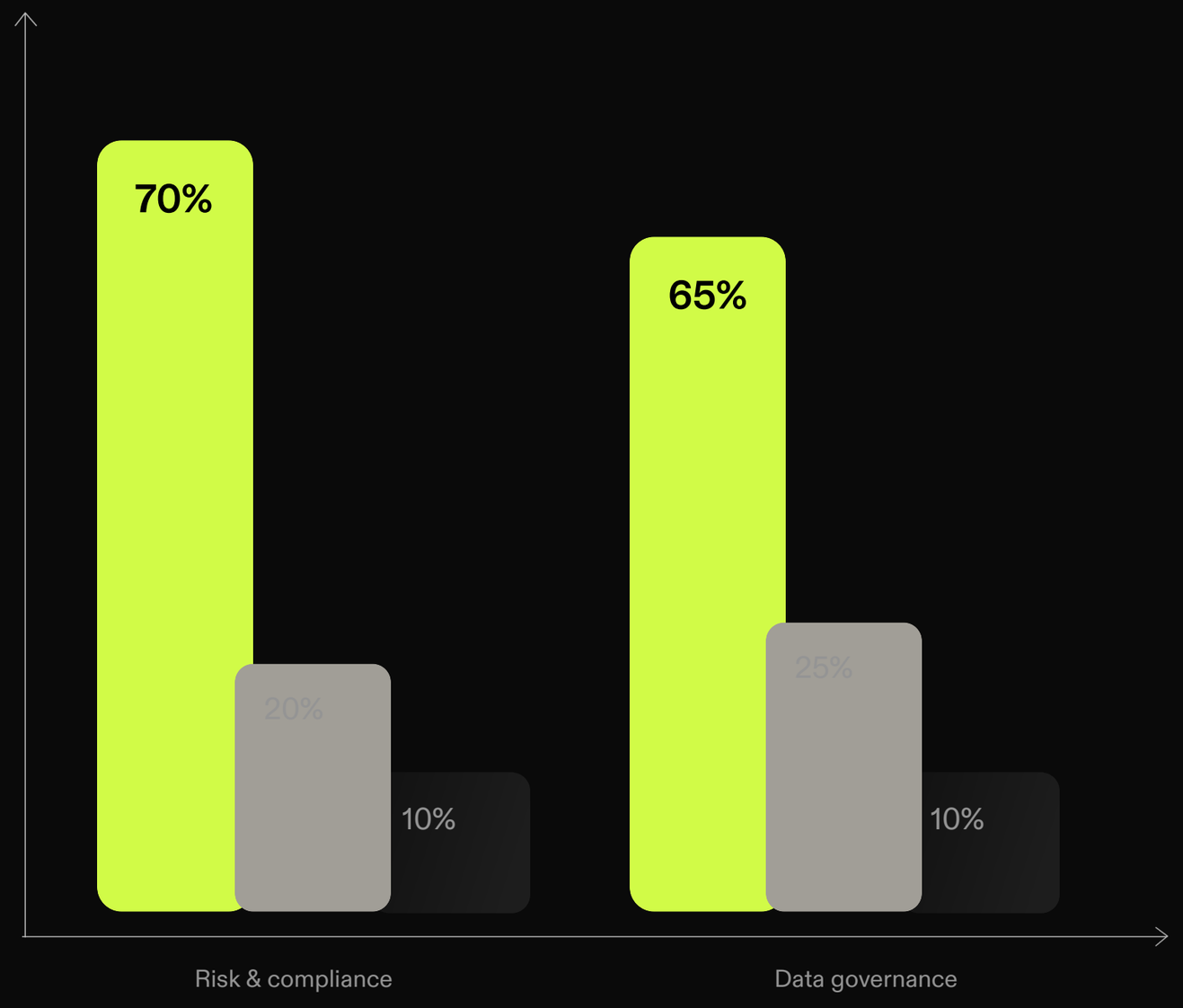
71% regularly use gen AI in at least one business function

- Marketing & sales
- Service operations
- Product development
- Information technology

Most common use cases



Organizations that use AI in ≥1 business function from 2024 to 2025



Organizational Structures & Governance

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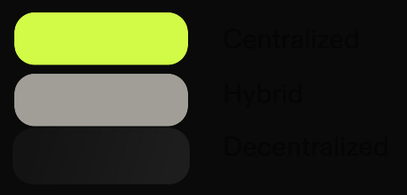


Organizational Structures & Governance

Redesigning workflows around generative AI is the most important driver of measurable business impact. While most organizations experiment with AI within existing processes, only a small share have restructured workflows to fully integrate gen AI. This shift is crucial — it enables efficiency gains, unlocks EBIT contribution, and separates early adopters from true value creators.

Initial adoption

78% of organizations use AI in at least one function

Generative AI deployment

71% of respondents now use gen AI in at least one function

Workflow redesign

McKinsey explicitly highlights this as the single strongest driver of EBIT impact

Scaling & governance

The report stresses adoption roadmaps, KPIs, and governance practices

Business impact

Just 17% of orgs attribute ≥5% of EBIT to gen AI, but redesigned workflows correlate strongly with value capture

27%

of organizations review all gen AI outputs before use

Monitoring & Quality Oversight of Gen AI Outputs

Organizations vary widely in how they review generative AI outputs before use. Some maintain strict oversight, checking every output, while others review only a small fraction. Industries such as professional services, legal, and business functions tend to apply more rigorous review processes, while other sectors adopt lighter-touch approaches.
This inconsistency highlights the growing need for robust quality assurance frameworks to ensure trust, accuracy, and safe deployment at scale.

Business

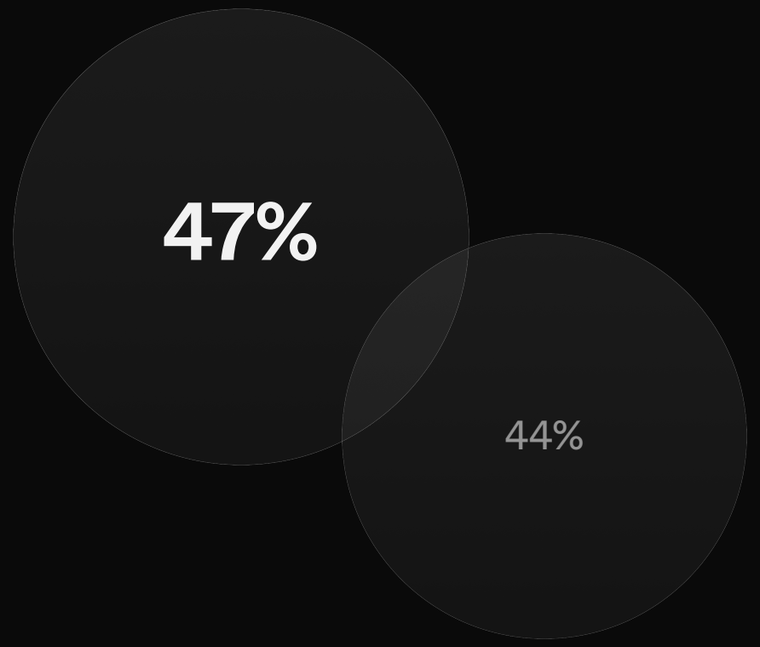
Legal

≤20%

A similar share reviews only ≤20 % of outputs

Monitoring & Quality Oversight of Gen AI Outputs

As AI and generative AI adoption expand, organizations face heightened exposure to risks. While many companies are beginning to establish safeguards, only a fraction have comprehensive risk management frameworks. Larger organizations tend to mitigate more risks than smaller peers, yet critical gaps remain
in accuracy, explainability, and governance.



Survey & insights

47% of organizations reported at least one negative consequence from gen AI use
(up from 44% earlier).

Larger organizations are **more likely to mitigate risks**, but adoption of practices like explainability and quality controls remains inconsistent.

Risk frameworks are evolving but still **lag behind adoption speed**, creating exposure to regulatory, reputational, and operational risks.

Key Risks Being Addressed

- Inaccuracy & Hallucinations
- Cybersecurity Threats
- Intellectual Property (IP) Infringement
- Privacy & Data Protection
- Bias & Fairness

Adoption & Scaling Best Practices

McKinsey identified 12 best practices for adopting and scaling generative AI. These include elements such as having a clear roadmap, defining KPIs, embedding incentives, ensuring feedback loops, and setting up dedicated teams. Each of these practices correlates positively with measurable financial impact (EBIT gains).

- The survey tracked 12 best practices in gen AI adoption & scaling
- Each practice **positively correlates to EBIT impact**
- But **actual uptake is low:**

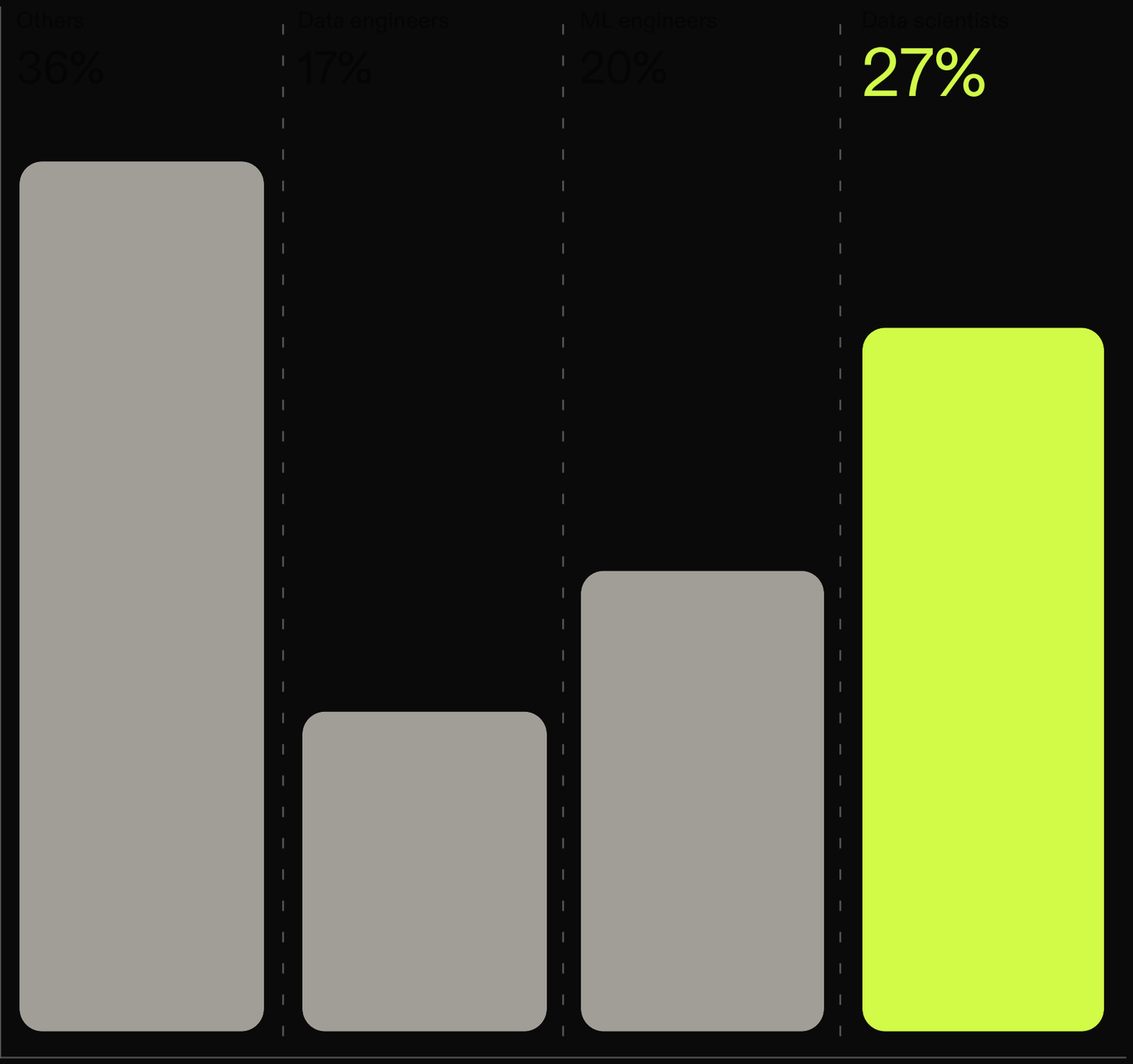
  < 1/3 say they follow most of the 12 practices

  < 20% track KPIs for genAI
- Larger firms more likely to **adopt these practices**

Workforce Impacts, Hiring, & Reskilling

AI adoption is reshaping workforce dynamics. Organizations are actively hiring for technical and compliance roles, with data scientists, ML engineers, and data engineers in highest demand, while AI ethics specialists remain rare.

Many companies have already reskilled employees, and most plan further reskilling in the next three years to adapt to AI-driven workflows. Time saved through automation is being redirected toward new activities and expanded responsibilities, though some functions — particularly service and supply chain — anticipate headcount reductions.



Organizations that combine workflow redesign, robust governance, risk management, and workforce reskilling will be best positioned to unlock sustainable value from AI.

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